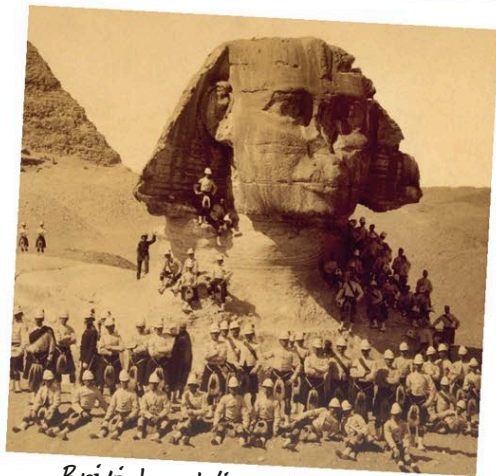




British soldiers in front of the Sphinx in Egypt, 1882

A railroad that connected the two ends of the huge Russian Empire was built between 1891 and 1916.



Trans-Siberian Railroad

The Scramble for Africa

Between 1884 and 1885, the European nations met in Berlin, Germany, to divide up Africa between themselves. By 1900, all but two African countries—Liberia and Ethiopia—were European colonies.

KEY (1900)

Ottoman Empire

British Empire

French Empire

Danish Empire

Spanish Empire

Portuguese Empire

Dutch Empire

German Empire

Russian Empire

Japanese Empire

Italian Empire

American Empire

Austro-Hungarian Empire

Belgian Empire

Persian Empire

Qing Empire

Independent nations

Goldfields
People rushed to newly discovered goldfields.

Steamships
These ships carried emigrants to the United States and Canada. They were also used for trading with the colonies.



Hong Kong

The British Empire gained Hong Kong in 1842 and turned the island into a major business hub.

Queen Victoria

The British Empire

From 1837 to 1901, Queen Victoria ruled the British Empire. By 1900, the empire ruled over 412 million people—almost a quarter of the world's population at the time.